

English Vocabulary

PUBLICATION METADATA

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BOOK HIGHLIGHTS & LEARNING FEATURES

- ' Structured 14-Section Comprehensive Mastery Layout
- ' Visual Memory Cards, Mnemonics & Sound Associations
- ' Exam Trend Analysis, PYQ Notes & Shortcut Formulas
- ' High-Retention Active Recall & Common Mistake Alerts
- ' Quick Revision Summary & One-Page Exam Formula Sheet

WORDS (M-GROUP)

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will master the following competencies:

- Semantic Precision: Identify, define, and correctly utilize 24 elite, high-frequency "M-Group" vocabulary words.
- Morphological Analysis: Break down complex words using Greek and Latin roots, prefixes, and suffixes to decode unfamiliar terms in exam environments.
- Contextual Application: Match words with their precise grammatical roles (parts of speech) and collocations in sentence-completion questions.
- Strategic Elimination: Apply tone analysis, positive/negative word charge, and semantic clustering to solve competitive exam questions (SSC, Bank PO, GRE, UPSC, State PSC) with maximum speed and accuracy.

Quick Overview & Chapter Roadmap

Competitive exams do not merely test whether you know a word; they test if you understand its subtle nuances, its grammatical limitations, and its secondary meanings. This chapter focuses on a critical cluster of words starting with the letter 'M' (from Mendacious to Morose) that are notorious for appearing in sentence equivalence, cloze tests, and reading comprehension passages.

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% THE "M-GROUP" LEXICON ROADMAP %

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% HUMAN CHARACTER %	% NOXIOUS & STINK %	% ACTION & PACIFY %
100	0	0
90	10	0
80	20	0
70	30	0
60	40	0
50	50	0
40	60	0
30	70	0
20	80	0
10	90	0
0	100	0
0	0	100
0	0	90
0	0	80
0	0	70
0	0	60
0	0	50
0	0	40
0	0	30
0	0	20
0	0	10
0	0	0

% & ATTRIBUTES % % ENVIRONMENTS % % PROCESSES %

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% • Mendacious (adj)% % • Mephitic (adj) % % • Militate (v) %

% • Mendicant (n)	%	% • Miasma (n)	%	% • Mitigate (v)	%
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% • Mercenary (adj) % % % • Mollify (v) %

% • Meticulous (adj)% % • Molt (v) %

% • Mettle (n) %

% %

% • Misanthrope (n) %

% • Miscreant (n) %

% • Miser (n)	%
100	100
90	90
80	80
70	70
60	60
50	50
40	40
30	30
20	20
10	10
0	0

% • Morose (adj) %

% %

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Main Concepts & Formulas

Vocabulary acquisition is highly systematic. Rather than memorizing words in isolation, we utilize The Tri-Anchor Method: Root Origin, Semantic Association, and Grammatical Collocation.

Morphological Anchors (Prefixes, Roots, and Suffixes)

Understanding these core components allows you to deduce meanings instantly:

Root/Prefix/Suffix	Source Language	Core Meaning	High-Yield Examples
Mend-	Latin (Mendax / Menda)	Fault, defect, lie, physical blemish	Mendacious (lying), Amends (repairing a fault), Emend (correcting errors)
Mis- / Miso-	Greek (Misein)	Hatred, bad, wrong	Misanthrope (human-hater), Miscreant (evil-doer), Misogynist (woman-hater)
Mit- / Mitig-	Latin (Mitis)	Soft, mild, gentle	Mitigate (to make mild), Mitigator (one who softens pain)
Moll-	Latin (Mollis)	Soft	Mollify (to soften anger), Mollusk (soft-bodied invertebrate), Emollient (soothing moisturizer)
Mono-	Greek (Monos)	Single, alone, solitary	Monolithic (single massive stone), Monologue (speech by one person)

The Law of Semantic Charging (Polarity)

Every high-level word carries an emotional "charge" or "tone." In competitive exams, identifying this charge is your primary tool for eliminating incorrect options in sentence completion.

Word Polarity = $\begin{cases} \text{Positive (+)} & \text{e.g., Mettle (courage), Meticulous (precision), Mollify (soothe)} \\ \text{Neutral (0)} & \text{e.g., Metaphor (literary device), Mnemonic (memory tool), Molt (shedding)} \\ \text{Negative (-)} & \text{e.g., Mendacious (lying), Mephitic (foul), Morose (gloomy)} \end{cases}$

Detailed Explanations & Theory

Here is an exhaustive, academic dissection of the 24 primary words. Each entry contains etymological history, grammatical restrictions, and fine semantic differences to prevent errors in high-stakes testing.

Mendacious (Adjective)

- Etymology: From Latin mendax (lying, deceitful), linked to menda* (fault or defect).
- Definition: Given to lying; habitually untruthful; dishonest; containing or based on falsehoods.
- Grammatical Collocation: Commonly modifies nouns like testimony, report, character, or propaganda*.
- Synonyms: Duplicitous, prevaricating, equivocal, mendax, dishonest, deceitful, perfidious.
- Antonyms: Veracious, candid, scrupulous, trustworthy, upright.

Mendicant (Noun / Adjective)

- Etymology: From Latin mendicant- (begging), from mendicus (beggar), originally implying someone with a physical defect (menda*).
- Definition: (n) A beggar; a member of a religious order forbidden to own property, who relies on alms; (adj) practicing begging; living on alms.
- Grammatical Collocation: Used historically for friars (mendicant orders*), or sociologically to describe impoverished populations.

- Synonyms: Beggar, almsman, pauper, cadger, suppliant.
- Antonyms: Benefactor, philanthropist, patron, donor.

Mephitic (Adjective)

- Etymology: From Latin mephitis* (a noxious, sulfurous exhalation from the earth).
- Definition: Offensive to the smell; foul-smelling; noxious; poisonous; pestilential.
- Grammatical Collocation: Typically describes gases, vapors, swamps, caverns, or subterranean atmospheres (mephitic vapors*).
- Synonyms: Fetid, noisome, noxious, malodorous, putrid, noisome.
- Antonyms: Fragrant, aromatic, redolent, balmy, wholesome.

Mercenary (Adjective / Noun)

- Etymology: From Latin mercenarius (one hired for wages), from merces* (pay, reward, wages).
- Definition: (adj) Motivated solely by a desire for monetary or material gain; greedy; hired for service in a foreign army; (n) a professional soldier hired to serve in a foreign army.
- Grammatical Collocation: Mercenary motives, mercenary army, mercenary politician*.
- Synonyms: Venal, acquisitive, avaricious, covetous, hireling.
- Antonyms: Altruistic, philanthropic, disinterested, idealistic.

Mercurial (Adjective)

- Etymology: From the Roman god Mercury (the swift-footed messenger of the gods) and the planet Mercury, traditionally associated with volatility.
- Definition: Subject to sudden, unpredictable, or volatile changes in mood, temperament, or mind; animated; sprightly; quick-witted.
- Grammatical Collocation: Mercurial temperament, mercurial markets, mercurial weather*.
- Synonyms: Volatile, capricious, fickle, erratic, mutable, protean.
- Antonyms: Stolid, phlegmatic, steadfast, immutable, immutable.

Meretricious (Adjective)

- Etymology: From Latin meretricius (of or pertaining to a prostitute), from meretrix (prostitute), from merere* (to earn money).
- Definition: Deceptively attractive; alluring by a show of vulgar, cheap, or flashy attractions; tawdry; based on pretense or insincerity.
- Grammatical Collocation: Meretricious ornament, meretricious style, meretricious arguments*.
- Synonyms: Specious, tawdry, garish, loud, showy, superficial, flashy.
- Antonyms: Genuine, authentic, understated, unadorned, sincere.

Metaphor (Noun)

- Etymology: From Greek metapherein (to transfer), from meta (over, across) + pherein* (to carry).
- Definition: A figure of speech in which a term or phrase is applied to something to which it is not literally applicable in order to suggest a resemblance; an implied comparison.
- Grammatical Collocation: Extended metaphor, mixed metaphor, dead metaphor*.
- Synonyms: Analogy, simile (implied), trope, allegory, symbol.
- Antonyms: Literal statement, plain truth, fact.

Meticulous (Adjective)

- Etymology: Originally from Latin meticulous (fearful, timid), from metus* (fear). Over centuries, the meaning shifted from "fearful of making mistakes" to "showing extreme care about minute details."
- Definition: Taking or showing extreme care about minute details; extremely careful; precise; thorough; scrupulous.
- Grammatical Collocation: Meticulous planning, meticulous research, meticulous housekeeper*.

- Synonyms: Fastidious, punctilious, painstaking, scrupulous, assiduous.
- Antonyms: Negligent, slipshod, remiss, cursory, sloppy.

Mettle (Noun)

- Etymology: A 16th-century spelling variant of the word metal*. It was used metaphorically to denote the "temper" or "quality" of a person's character, much like tempering steel.
- Definition: Courage and fortitude; spirit; resolution; inherent temperament or character quality.
- Grammatical Collocation: To test one's mettle, show one's mettle, men of mettle*.
- Synonyms: Fortitude, grit, pluck, valor, resolution, doughtiness.
- Antonyms: Cowardice, timidity, spinelessness, cravenness.

Miasma (Noun)

- Etymology: From Greek miasma (stain, defilement, pollution), from miainein* (to pollute).
- Definition: A noxious, poisonous, or foul-smelling atmosphere, vapor, or fog; a dangerous, foreboding, or corruptive influence that surrounds or permeates something.
- Grammatical Collocation: Miasma of corruption, swamp miasma, spiritual miasma*.
- Synonyms: Effluvium, vapor, noxious air, pollution, atmosphere, aura.
- Antonyms: Sweetness, purity, cleanliness, ozone.

Militate (Verb)

- Etymology: From Latin militare (to serve as a soldier), from miles* (soldier).
- Definition: To have a substantial effect, force, or influence; to operate or work (usually followed by the preposition against* to mean working to prevent a certain outcome).
- Grammatical Collocation: To militate against success, to militate against adoption*.
- Synonyms: Oppose, counter, conflict with, hinder, counteract, prejudice.
- Antonyms: Aid, abet, assist, promote, foster, facilitate.

Minatory (Adjective)

- Etymology: From Late Latin minatorius (threatening), from minari* (to threaten).
- Definition: Threatening; menacing; expressing or conveying a threat.
- Grammatical Collocation: Minatory gesture, minatory letter, minatory glare*.
- Synonyms: Menacing, threatening, ominous, sinister, baleful.
- Antonyms: Propitious, auspicious, encouraging, comforting, reassuring.

Mince (Verb)

- Etymology: From Old French mincier (to cut into small pieces), from Late Latin minutiare (to make small), from minutus* (small).
- Definition: To cut or chop into very small pieces; to walk with short, dainty, affected steps; to speak with affected elegance or politeness; to moderate or weaken the force of one's words (especially in the idiom not to mince words*).
- Grammatical Collocation: Mincing gait, not mincing words, minced meat*.
- Synonyms: Chop, fragment; dally, pose; soften, palliate, moderate.
- Antonyms: Speak bluntly, blurt out, enlarge, expand.

Misanthrope (Noun)

- Etymology: From Greek misanthropos (hating mankind), from misein (to hate) + anthropos* (man, human being).
 - Definition: A hater of humankind; a person who dislikes, distrusts, or avoids human society and humanity.
 - Grammatical Collocation: Sometimes used interchangeably with cynic, but misanthrope* specifically targets humanity as a whole.
 - Synonyms: Cynic, pessimist, recluse, skeptic, humbug.
 - Antonyms: Philanthropist, humanitarian, altruist.
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Miscellany (Noun)

- Etymology: From Latin miscellanea (mixed writings, writings on various subjects), from miscellus (mixed), from miscere* (to mix).
- Definition: A collection of various items, parts, or ingredients; a mixture; a book or booklet containing a selection of miscellaneous literary works, essays, or poems.
- Grammatical Collocation: Literary miscellany, a miscellany of odd objects*.
- Synonyms: Assortment, potpourri, medley, farrago, hodgepodge, salmagundi.
- Antonyms: Monolith, homogeneous entity, uniform collection.

Miscreant (Noun / Adjective)

- Etymology: From Old French mescreant (disbelieving, heretical), from mes- (wrongly) + creire* (to believe). In the Middle Ages, a disbeliever or heretic was associated with immoral behavior, shifting the meaning to "scoundrel."
- Definition: (n) A vicious, unprincipled, or depraved person; a villain; a scoundrel; (adj) depraved; villainous; unprincipled.
- Grammatical Collocation: Hardened miscreant, miscreant behavior*.
- Synonyms: Scoundrel, villain, evildoer, reprobate, rascal, blackguard, knave.
- Antonyms: Saint, moralist, paragon, savior, hero.

Miser (Noun)

- Etymology: From Latin miser* (wretched, unfortunate, pitiful). The semantic development refers to the wretched state of a person who hoards wealth but lives in voluntary poverty.
- Definition: A person who lives in wretched circumstances in order to hoard and save money; a stingy, avaricious person; a skinflint.
- Grammatical Collocation: A parsimonious miser, miserly hoarding*.
- Synonyms: Skinflint, niggard, churl, tightwad, hoarder, pinchpenny.
- Antonyms: Spendthrift, squanderer, prodigal, philanthropist.

Mishap (Noun)

- Etymology: From Middle English mis- (badly, wrongly) + hap* (chance, luck, fortune).
- Definition: An unfortunate, minor accident; a piece of bad luck; an untoward event.
- Grammatical Collocation: A minor mishap, without further mishap*.
- Synonyms: Accident, misadventure, misfortune, casualty, setback.
- Antonyms: Windfall, stroke of luck, blessing, boon.

Mitigate (Verb)

- Etymology: From Latin mitigatus, past participle of mitigare (to make mild or soft), from mitis (mild, gentle) + agere* (to make/do).
- Definition: To make mild, soft, or gentle; to moderate; to lessen the severity, force, or pain of; to alleviate or appease.
- Grammatical Collocation: Mitigate punishment, mitigate pain, mitigating circumstances*.
- Synonyms: Alleviate, assuage, palliate, mollify, extenuate, temper.
- Antonyms: Exacerbate, aggravate, inflame, worsen, heighten.

Mnemonic (Adjective / Noun)

- Etymology: From Greek mnemonikos (mindful, pertaining to memory), from mneme (memory), associated with Mnemosyne* (the Greek goddess of memory).
- Definition: (adj) Assisting or intending to assist the memory; (n) a device, formula, or system of letters used as an aid in remembering.
- Grammatical Collocation: Mnemonic device, mnemonic trick*.
- Synonyms: Memory aid, associative clue, prompt.
- Antonyms: Amnestic, forgetful, obliative.

Mollify (Verb)

- Etymology: From Latin mollificare (to make soft), from mollis (soft) + facere* (to make).
- Definition: To soften in feeling, temper, or anger; to pacify; to appease; to mitigate or reduce the tenderness of; to make soft.
- Grammatical Collocation: Mollify an angry customer, mollify opposition*.
- Synonyms: Placate, pacify, appease, propitiate, conciliate.
- Antonyms: Provoke, aggravate, enrage, incense, exasperate.

Molt (Verb / Noun)

- Etymology: From Latin mutare (to change). The 'l' in English was inserted due to association with Old English mowen* (to change).
- Definition: (v) To cast or shed the feathers, skin, horns, hair, or outer covering periodically, with new growth replacing the old; (n) the act or process of shedding an outer covering.
- Grammatical Collocation: Snakes molt their skins; birds molt* feathers during seasonal changes.
- Synonyms: Shed, slough, cast off, exfoliate.
- Antonyms: Retain, accumulate, grow.

Monolithic (Adjective)

- Etymology: From Greek monolithos (made of a single stone), from monos (single) + lithos* (stone).
- Definition: Made of a single, massive block of stone; consisting of one massive, uniform, and unbreakable structure; characterized by complete uniformity and invulnerability to change.
- Grammatical Collocation: Monolithic pillar, monolithic organization, monolithic state*.
- Synonyms: Uniform, colossal, massive, solid, undivided, homogeneous.
- Antonyms: Fragmented, heterogeneous, diverse, multifaceted, pluralistic.

Morose (Adjective)

- Etymology: From Latin morosus (peevish, fastidious, fretful), from mos* (manner, habit, whim, or self-will). The meaning transitioned to denote a sullen, gloomy, or sour disposition.
- Definition: Gloomily or sullenly ill-tempered; sour-tempered; expressing gloom or melancholy.
- Grammatical Collocation: Morose disposition, morose silence, morose individual*.
- Synonyms: Sullen, glum, melancholy, churlish, saturnine, splenetic.
- Antonyms: Cheerful, jovial, sanguine, blithe, jaunty, vivacious.

Worked Examples & Applications

Contextual Sentence Completion (Fill in the Blanks)

Examine how context clues determine the correct word selection.

Example 1:

The whistleblower exposed the company's ____________________ accounting practices, which had deceptively inflated stock values for years before the collapse.

- (A) meticulous
- (B) mendacious
- (C) monolithic
- (D) mercurial

KEY NOTE

Ø=ÜÖ WORKED SOLUTION:

KEY NOTE

(D) mercenary: Means motivated solely by money. While a senator might be greedy, the sentence explicitly links his actions to volatility* and changing policies, not direct cash bribes.

KEY NOTE

Correct Answer: (C)

PYQ Discussion & Exam Trends

PREVIOUS YEAR TREND: Double-Blank Fillers & Sentence Equivalence

In recent SSC CGL (Tier-II) and Bank PO exams, examiners have combined homophones or related M-words to test your ability to make fine distinctions.

Classic Exam Question:

Directions: Choose the pair of words that best fits the blanks in the sentence below.

"The negotiator attempted to _____ the furious workers by offering concessions, but the company's strict financial constraints continued to _____ against a final settlement."

- (A) mitigate ... militate
- (B) mollify ... militate
- (C) mollify ... mitigate
- (D) militate ... mollify

EXAM TREND & FOCUS

EXAM FOCUS & ANALYTICAL ANALYSIS:

KEY NOTE

This question tests the precise usage of mollify, mitigate, and militate.

KEY NOTE

KEY NOTE

First Blank Analysis: The object is "furious workers". You pacify, soothe, or calm angry people. Both mollify and placate are used for people. Mitigate is used to reduce the severity of things (e.g., pain, punishment, or circumstances), not people. Therefore, the first blank must be mollify.

KEY NOTE

Second Blank Analysis: The context is "constraints continued to [work against] a final settlement". The verb that means "to work against or have weight against" (usually followed by against) is militate.

KEY NOTE

Conclusion: We need mollify in the first blank and militate in the second.

KEY NOTE

KEY NOTE

Correct Answer: (B)

Shortcuts & Exam Tricks

&j EXAM SHORTCUT

&j SHORTCUT 1: The Preposition Match Trick

KEY NOTE

Some vocabulary verbs are grammatically tied to specific prepositions. If you memorize these pairings, you can solve blank-filling questions instantly without reading the entire sentence.

KEY NOTE

Militate + AGAINST \rightarrow "to work against" (almost always followed by against*).

KEY NOTE

Mitigate + [Direct Object] \rightarrow "to mitigate the pain" (never followed by against*).

&j EXAM SHORTCUT

&j SHORTCUT 2: Homophone Disambiguation Formula

KEY NOTE

When confused between Mettle and Meddle:

KEY NOTE

Mettle = Mental Strength = Courage \quad (Think: "Heavy Metal strength")

KEY NOTE

Meddle = Middle = Interfere \quad (Think: "Putting yourself in the middle of others' business")

Memory Tricks & Mnemonics

To ensure long-term retention of these words, use these structural, phonetically associative mnemonics:

- Mendacious:
 - Link:* Mend + As + I + Us.
 - Mnemonic:* When a politician tries to mend a situation, he often tells mendacious (lying) stories to us.
- Mendicant:
 - Link: Mendi (looks like money*) + cant (can't).
 - Mnemonic:* A mendicant is a beggar who can't earn money.
- Mephitic:
 - Link:* Meth + Phyt (fight).
 - Mnemonic:* The smell of a meth lab will make your lungs fight because of the mephitic (foul/toxic) fumes.
- Meretricious:
 - Link:* Merit + Tricky + Us.
 - Mnemonic:* A meretricious display has no real merit; it is just a tricky way to fool us with flashy looks.
- Minatory:
 - Link:* Minotaur (the mythological bull-monster).
 - Mnemonic:* The towering Minotaur in the labyrinth was highly minatory (menacing/threatening).

Common Mistakes to Avoid

Ø=P" COMMON MISTAKE ALERT

Ø=P" COMMON MISTAKE: Confusing Mitigate, Militate, and Mollify

KEY NOTE

Many aspirants lose marks by mixing up these three highly active verbs.

KEY NOTE

Mitigate: To lessen the severity of a situation* (e.g., "mitigate the crisis").

KEY NOTE

Mollify: To pacify or soothe an angry person* (e.g., "mollify the crying child").

KEY NOTE

Militate: To serve as a powerful factor against* something (e.g., "his bad record militates against his promotion").

KEY NOTE

KEY NOTE

Incorrect: "We tried to mitigate the angry boss."

KEY NOTE

Correct: "We tried to mollify the angry boss" OR "We tried to mitigate the boss's anger."

Ø=P" COMMON MISTAKE ALERT

Ø=P" COMMON MISTAKE: Misunderstanding Meretricious

KEY NOTE

Do not confuse Meretricious with Meritorious. They are near-antonyms!

KEY NOTE

Meritorious = Deserving reward, praise, or esteem (root: merit*).

KEY NOTE

Meretricious = Flashy, cheap, attractive but without real value (root: prostitute*).

Summary & Key Takeaways

1. Character Trait Clusters: Learn to group your vocabulary. Morose and morose describe sullen gloom, while mettle is the steel-like courage of an individual.
2. Precision over Approximation: Knowing that meticulous means "careful" is helpful, but knowing it implies "extreme precision down to the smallest detail" is what gets you the correct answer on advanced exams.
3. Grammatical Fits: Pay close attention to transitive verbs like mollify and mitigate, intransitive verbs like militate (which require against), and noun-only terms like miasma.

Practice Questions with Solutions

Directions (Q1-Q10): Choose the word closest in meaning to the capitalized word.

METICULOUS

- (A) slovenly
- (B) fastidious
- (C) volatile
- (D) mercenary

KEY NOTE

' SOLUTION: (B). Meticulous means showing great attention to detail, which is synonymous with fastidious or punctilious. Slovenly is an antonym (untidy/careless).

MEPHITIC

- (A) fragrant
- (B) cavernous
- (C) noisome
- (D) courageous

KEY NOTE

' SOLUTION: (C). Mephitic means foul-smelling or noxious. Noisome is its closest synonym. Fragrant is its antonym.

METTLE

- (A) brass
- (B) fortitude
- (C) interference
- (D) listlessness

KEY NOTE

' SOLUTION: (B). Mettle means spirit, courage, or fortitude. Interference confuses it with the verb meddle.

MINATORY

- (A) threatening
- (B) miniature
- (C) advisory
- (D) reassuring

KEY NOTE

' SOLUTION: (A). Minatory comes from the root for "threat" (like menace) and means threatening.

MOLLIFY

- (A) irritate
- (B) soften
- (C) pacify
- (D) condense

KEY NOTE

' SOLUTION: (C). While mollify literally comes from "making soft," its primary figurative and contextual meaning is to pacify or soothe anger.

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Directions (Q6-Q10): Fill in the blanks with the most appropriate word.

The doctor tried to \ \ \ \ \ \ \ \ \ \ \ \ \ \ \ \ the patient's excruciating pain by administering a local anesthetic.

- (A) mollify
- (B) militate
- (C) mitigate
- (D) molt

KEY NOTE

' SOLUTION: (C). Pain is a physical condition or sensation, so we use mitigate (to lessen the severity of a thing). Mollify is used for human anger/emotions.

- (A) meretricious
- (B) mephitic
- (C) meticulous
- (D) mercurial

KEY NOTE

' SOLUTION: (B). The clues "crypt", "stench of decay", and "dread" point to a foul, toxic atmosphere. Mephitic fits perfectly.

Although she tried to look upbeat, her _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ expression during the meeting made it clear she was deeply unhappy with the decision.

- (A) meticulous
- (B) monolithic
- (C) morose
- (D) mercenary

KEY NOTE

' SOLUTION: (C). Her expression made it clear she was "deeply unhappy", indicating a sullen, gloomy look, which is morose.

The castle's tower was a \ \ \ \ \ \ \ \ \ \ \ \ \ \ structure, carved entirely from a single massive piece of granite.

- (A) monolithic
- (B) meticulous
- (C) mercurial
- (D) meretricious

KEY NOTE

' SOLUTION: (A). The clue "carved entirely from a single massive piece of granite" directly points to monolithic (mono = single, lithos = stone).

We knew he was a purely ___ advisor when we discovered he was secretly taking payments from our competitors to influence our decisions.

- (A) mercurial
- (B) mercenary
- (C) mendacious
- (D) mendicant

KEY NOTE

' SOLUTION: (B). Taking payments from competitors to influence decisions is the definition of mercenary behavior (motivated solely by money/hireling).

Final One-Page Quick Revision Sheet

Word	POS	Core Meaning	Target Synonyms	Target Antonyms	Key Context Clue / Collocation
Mendacious	Adj	Lying; untruthful	Dishonest, Deceitful	Veracious, Honest	Mendacious statement
Mendicant	N/Adj	Begging; beggar	Pauper, Supplicant	Benefactor, Patron	Mendicant friars
Mephitic	Adj	Foul-smelling; toxic	Fetid, Noisome	Fragrant, Aromatic	Mephitic vapors/fumes
Mercenary	Adj/N	Motivated by money	Venal, Greedy	Altruistic, Generous	Mercenary motives
Mercurial	Adj	Volatile; rapidly changing	Capricious, Fickle	Stolid, Immutable	Mercurial temperament
Meretricious	Adj	Cheaply flashy; specious	Specious, Tawdry	Genuine, Authentic	Meretricious ornament
Meticulous	Adj	Extremely precise	Fastidious, Painstaking	Slovenly, Careless	Meticulous planning
Mettle	N	Courage; spirit	Fortitude, Grit	Cowardice, Fear	To test one's mettle
Miasma	N	Poisonous fog/air	Effluvium, Pollution	Purity, Clean Air	Miasma of corruption
Militate	V	Work against	Counteract, Hinder	Aid, Facilitate	Militate against progress
Minatory	Adj	Threatening; menacing	Ominous, Sinister	Reassuring, Auspicious	Minatory gestures
Misanthrope	N	Hater of humanity	Cynic, Hermit	Philanthropist	He lived as a misanthrope
Miscreant	N	Villain; scoundrel	Reprobate, Rascal	Saint, Hero	The miscreant fled
Mitigate	V	Soften; lessen pain	Alleviate, Assuage	Exacerbate, Aggravate	Mitigate the disaster
Mollify	V	Pacify; soothe anger	Placate, Appease	Enrage, Provoke	Mollify an angry person
Monolithic	Adj	Massive and uniform	Homogeneous, Solid	Fragmented, Pluralistic	Monolithic organization
Morose	Adj	Gloomy; sullenly sad	Glum, Saturnine	Cheerful, Sanguine	Morose disposition

' QUICK REVISION

' FINAL REVISION: Memorize the prepositions! Militate always goes with against. Memorize the semantic targets! You mollify a person's anger, but you mitigate a crisis or pain.

WORD: MENDICANT

• Meaning: A beggar; relying on alms.

• Sound Association: "Men can't pay"

• Funny Trick: Picture a group of "men who can't" pay for their food, so they sit outside the restaurant begging for coins.

"Men-can't-pay" are mendicants!

• Example Sentence: The old mendicant sat on the temple steps, holding out his wooden bowl.

WORD: MERETRICIOUS

• Meaning: Cheaply flashy; deceptively attractive.

• Sound Association: "Merry tricks"

• Funny Trick: Imagine a street magician performing "merry tricks" with fake gold coins. It looks beautiful from a distance, but up close, it is just meretricious junk.

• Example Sentence: The lobby was decorated with meretricious gold-painted plastic chandeliers.

[illegible]

% • Sound Association: "Miss Anthropos" %

% refuses to spend even one dollar on a hot meal. He is a miser! %

[illegible]

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[illegible]

% WORD: MOLLIFY %

[illegible]

% • Meaning: Soothe, calm, pacify (an angry person). %

% • Sound Association: "Molly fly!" %

% • Funny Trick: Imagine an angry toddler named Molly throwing a tantrum.%

% To mollify her, you hand her a toy airplane and yell, "Molly, fly!" %

% Suddenly, she calms down and smiles. %

% • Example Sentence: The manager mollified the angry customer by %

% offering a full refund and a free gift. %

[illegible]

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[illegible]

% WORD: MOLT %

[illegible]

% • Meaning: Shed hair, skin, or feathers. %

% • Sound Association: "Melting outer coat" %

% • Funny Trick: Imagine a bird whose feathers look like they are %

% "melting" off during the summer heat. It is just bird molting! %

% • Example Sentence: Our pet parrot looks a bit patchy because he is %

% about to molt his feathers. %

[illegible]

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[illegible]

% WORD: MONOLITHIC %

[illegible]

% • Meaning: Massive, uniform, solid. %

% • Sound Association: "Mono (Single) Lith (Stone)" %

% • Funny Trick: Picture a giant, single stone block standing alone in %

% the desert. It is monolithic, and nothing can break it. %

% • Example Sentence: The monolithic corporate giant controlled over %

% ninety percent of the global market. %

[illegible]

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[illegible]

% WORD: MOROSE %

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